

OREGON CITY COURIER

Published Thursdays from the Courier Building, Eighth Street, and entered in the Postoffice at Oregon City, Ore., as 2nd class mail matter

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Subscription Price \$1.50. Telephones, Pacific 51; Home A-51

THIS PAPER REPRESENTED FOR FOREIGN ADVERTISING BY THE

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STOP THE WASTE

It is one of the strange things about "level headed Americans" that they delight to waste their money. In most business matters they are the leaders of the world; in big affairs they count the cost to the last fraction of a mill—but in little everyday things they are worse than kids.

For instance, they permit two rival telephone companies to force them to use two telephone systems, when one would be just as good and cost a lot less money. They pay for two services, neither one of which is adequate, and yet both of which duplicate each other to a large degree. And they think that because they have two telephone companies that they are saving money. Somehow they think the two companies are going to cut each other's throats, and give them a better service for less. But the telephone companies only appear to compete in one direction—and that is as to which can give the least service for the price charged.

There is no excuse for a duplication of telephone service. Progressive cities like Seattle and Tacoma have discovered that, and have abolished the weaker of the two concerns. Cities like Portland and the county seat, however, still delight in the senseless duplication and aggravating inconvenience of two telephone systems. It is about time that Oregon City woke up, and took the first step to getting economical service. This first step would be for the council to order an interchange of calls on the two local systems, so that a subscriber to either line might get service over the other. If this was done, there would be very soon but one telephone company operating in this neck of the woods.

While city people suffer financially and otherwise from this senseless double graft, the farmer is the man who suffers most of all. And Oregon City eventually will rise or fall because the farmers do business here; so for its own protection it should try to save the waste and inconvenience of the double phone system. The farmer needs to be able to reach everybody in the county seat when he goes to his telephone. The various farmers' telephone circuits in territory tributary to Oregon City, are not connected with both local systems. If there was only one phone system here, the farmer could talk to any store, businessman or official. As it is now, he is limited to the stores that have a phone connected with his line. And as long as the farmer cannot do telephone business with everybody in the county seat, just so long will the county seat not get all the farmer's business.

This needless duplication of local telephones is a nuisance, a waste, and a lack of business efficiency. It is a handicap to the town and to every person who tries to use the telephone to expedite business. There is no excuse for it but the greed of promoters and the people ought to see that there is a change.

"Printing with a punch"—at the Courier.



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THE BANK OF OREGON CITY

Oldest Bank in Clackamas County

A FUNNY STUNT

A minority of Oregon City's council last week pulled off a peculiar and humorous stunt, when they developed a new variety of economy, and turned down the sale of a bond issue to take up city warrants. Councilman Hackett, the leader of the minority—and rumored to be a candidate for mayor—explained the action, saying it was not the wish of himself and the councilmen allied with him for the city to go any further into debt.

So, to prevent further going into debt, Mr. Hackett and his aides voted to have the city pay six percent interest instead of five percent. This is a new brand of economy, which fortunately appears not to be endorsed by other councilmen. It is remarkable that Mr. Hackett should consider six percent interest more favorable than five percent—but perhaps he was looking at it from the receiving side of the fence.

Mr. Hackett also remarks that he doesn't think Oregon City ought to issue any more bonds. And to discourage the voters and taxpayers from so doing, the Hackett clique tried their hardest to block the sale of the elevator bonds. Maybe it is the council's forte to decide what the citizens of the county seat shall do with their own money. Evidently Mr. Hackett thinks it is; but some of the other councilmen and quite a number of the citizens and taxpayers seem to believe differently. They have the strange idea that the councilmen are supposed to represent the people, and are put in office to do the people's bidding.

Every now and then in history some servant of the people gets the Hackett idea, and thinks he is greater than the electorate that put him in office. And after this idea becomes firmly rooted, the servant doesn't stay on the job very long. If Mr. Hackett wants to be mayor of the county seat, it would be well for him to revise his system of "economy," and not to have quite such an exalted opinion of the duties of his office.

The same advice applies to the city lawn-mower sharpener, Mr. Templeton; and also to Mr. Cox, of the cold storage plant. As to Councilman "Jit" Van Aiken, he ought to know by this time that he has troubles enough ahead of him, without joining the weird "economy" gang.

And speaking of him and Mr. Hackett; why don't they tell the council and the people the deep and dark secret that they paid ten dollars to uncover some months ago?

IT HAS COME!

Arising at a meeting of the Women's Homestead Association in Boston the other day, Mrs. Charlotte Smith, the president of the organization suggested that a wire cage ought to be built around stenographers while they are at work in business offices.

"Just as soon as his stenographer enters the office her employer ogles her, draws out a box of candy and gets closer," said Mrs. Smith. "A young girl can't do anything but bear it. Many a girl is afraid on account of her position. These old sinners take advantage of it. It's got to stop. I would have a law passed that no man can have a female stenographer his office without wire cage surrounding her."

After Madam president had finished her remarks and sat down, Mrs. Frank W. Page, a mere delegate, rose to say that perhaps if some wives showed their husbands more affection at home, there would not be such a crying need of wire cages. Mrs. Page did not look at anybody when she said this, but we bet a hat she was thinking of somebody present.

Personally we can't agree with Mrs. Smith as to the need of wire cages. In fact, until we entered the pure and ethical business of publishing a newspaper, we used to think that if wire cages were needed at all they ought to be around the boss, and not around the stenographers. And observation of the business world of recent years has not made us change our opinion a whole lot. We think the poor, tired businessman is more sinned against than otherwise, when the stenographer question comes up.

We know a stenographer, for instance, who takes almost a "motherly interest" in her boss, who puts flowers on his desk every morning when she comes down, who inquires if his headaches are better, and is ever willing to work overtime for her boss's sake. We knew another stenographer some years ago who pursued these tactics—and now she is the boss's wife. We have known quite a number of stenographers, in our checked career, who have married their bosses; and in every case into which we inquired afterwards, the boss was surprised when he discovered that he had been deprived of single blessedness.

The modern stenographer of today doesn't need a wire cage. Mrs. Smith, of Boston may think she does; but out here in the West we know better. We don't know just what the statistics are for Boston stenographers, but those it is our privilege to meet in former days all seem to be pretty successfully married now—and most of them married the boss. There are a great many more women than there

are men in dear old Boston, and of course all of the girls cannot be stenographers. And perhaps it was because of the other girls who didn't get such a good chance to marry the boss that Mrs. Smith's feelings were aroused.

At that, though, we like the cage idea—only we think the cage ought to be around the boss. Next time you come into the Courier office, if you see a brass railing around the sanctum, you will know why it has been installed. It will show that we have in his office without a wire cage surround us always like to prove that.

MORE ABOUT TAXES

The Courier is indebted to the American Economic League for the following. Somehow, it strikes us as being interesting.

For solution of the housing problem in cities, four of the nine members of the Commission on Industrial Relations recommend that:

"Special attention should be given to taxation in order that land should, as far as possible, be forced into use and the burden of taxation be removed from home owners."

For solution of the agricultural landlord and tenant problem, they found it necessary to recommend:

"The revision of the taxation system so as to exempt from taxation all improvements, and tax unused land at its full rental value."

For solution of the problem of unemployment, they found after long investigation that whatever else may seem to be necessary, the one thing that cannot be neglected is:

"The forcing of all unused land into use by making the tax on non-productive the same as on productive land of the same kind, and exempting all improvements."

wealth are certainly rich. Some of them are aggressive, and most of them are unarmed, but if they are in danger of disaster through attack by the people nearest them, no one seems aware of it; not even the Colonel himself. In the same country with them are millions of people who in spite of industry and economy have nothing. These have been unjustly deprived of the fruits of their labor through unjust laws. But they harbor no intention of attacking any who may be rich, even though they be also aggressive and unarmed. Calm yourself, Colonel!

HOW IT FIGURES

Mr. William E. Stone, who once upon a time was appointed city attorney of the county seat, and who was not re-appointed, appears to be the leading spirit in an initiative measure to alter Oregon City's charter, so that in the future the city attorney and the city recorder shall be elected instead of appointed. Mr. Stone says he is going to be a candidate at the primaries for the republican nomination for district attorney.

Under the present arrangement the city attorney gets a salary of seventy-five dollars a month, and the city recorder gets eight-five dollars. Under the corrupt practices act a candidate may spend 15 percent of his anticipated salary for expenses in the primaries, and ten percent for expenses in the general election. Thus, if the Stone charter amendment should carry, the candidates for city attorney could spend legally \$135 to get the nomination; and then, if they got that, they might spend \$90 more to try and get elected.

Mr. Stone has before this remarked that he was going to limit his election expenses in pursuing the republic

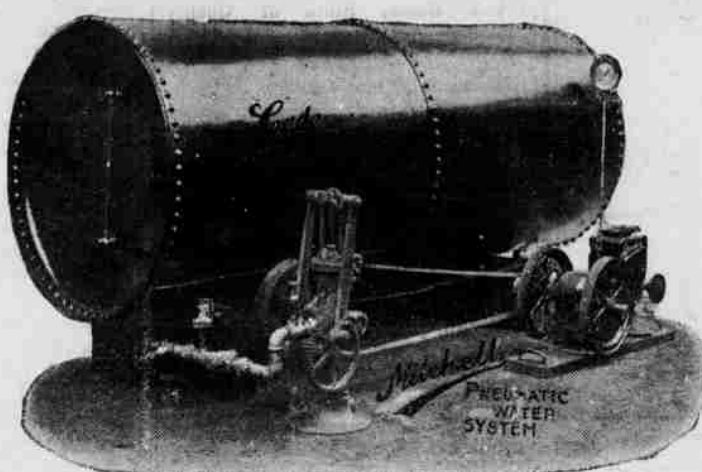
Wolf Howls

It must have been joy for Dr. J. A. Van Brakle, formerly the only osteopathic health officer in the world, to read the proceedings of the Oregon State Medical Association in Portland last week. His old friend, Dr. Calvin S. White and Andrew C. Smith were discussing the election of a secretary, and one of them said to the other: "You're as white-livered as a chicken." And the other replied: "You're a . . . liar." Truly, that was an "ethical" meeting.

With school days drawing near we note that M. J. Brown springs this one in the Benton County Courier:

"Two boys went to market with 60 ducks. The larger boy took 30 of the largest ducks and sold them two for \$1. The smaller boy took the remaining ducks and sold them three for \$1. They received for their ducks \$25. When they got home they told their father that they had sold their ducks at the rate of five for \$2 and gave him \$24. Explain how it was possible for the boys to make the dollar by this transaction."

Pretty soon our young hopefuls will be bringing home puzzles like that to do in their "lessons." And, Oregon having gone dry, we wonder if the arithmetic books have been censored, so as to exclude the old "example" that reads thusly: "A man buys five gallons of whiskey at four dollars a gallon and mixes it with four gallons of water, selling the product at a dollar a quart. What percent does he make?"

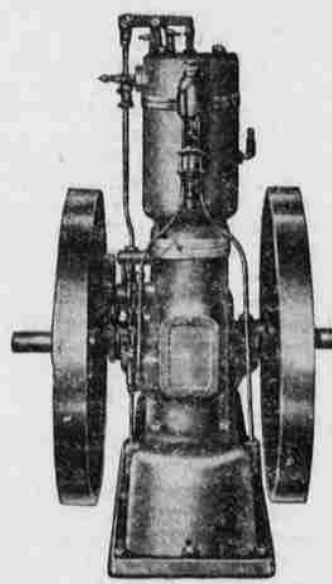


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In short, whatever industrial question they studied relating to social unrest, they found the land question at the bottom.

ANSWER TO TEDDY

One of our single tax friends calls our attention to the following, apropos of some recent mouthings of Kerne Roosevelt. We suspect that there is probably single tax thunder hidden away in it, but at that we are going to take a chance and print it. The answer to Teddy follows:

"The surest way for a nation to invite disaster," says Colonel Roosevelt, "is to be rich, aggressive and unarmed." That should not cause much nervousness in a nation where 65 percent of the people own only five percent of its wealth. In such a country the masses must be very poor. The fact that they are in that condition shows in itself that they are not aggressive, and as to being unarmed; none but a violent revolutionist would consider that an evil. So why be concerned about what may happen to a "rich, aggressive" and unarmed people?"

Possibly Colonel Roosevelt's hysteria about possible disaster to a "rich, aggressive and unarmed nation" is disproven by conditions in the United States. Two percent of the people who own 60 percent of the national

can nomination to "not more than forty dollars." As he feels that way about it, it is not surprising that he thinks that a man of fit mentality to be a city attorney could "make a fight" for the office for \$135. But if one regards Mr. Stone as the associate for many years of the Hon. George C. Brownell, who is supposed to know all about politics, it is surprising to find him expecting any man to make a fight for any elective office with a limit of \$135 on his preliminary expenses, and \$90 on his final campaign.

Maybe Bill Stone can do it; but we doubt if the situation proposed in the Stone charter amendment will appeal strongly to any practical politician. There may be men who would spend nearly three months' salary to get a \$75-a-month elective job; but somehow we don't figure that men of that sort are of the calibre that make good city attorneys and recorders. In this town the city officials are usually men who go to considerable personal sacrifice to serve the people, because they feel it a duty of citizenship. Such men will accept an appointment as a mark of honor—but they won't "run for office" on a campaign fund of \$135.

The amendment doesn't listen like "better government."

"Printing with a punch"—at the Courier.

Maybe examples like that lead children to envy the saloonman. Who knows?

Does Cuba love America, the nation that set her free from the tyrannical rule of Spain? Oh yes, she loves her Uncle Sam. Witness this proof of it from a government report from Consul P. M. Griffith, at Santiago: "Horseshoe nails of German and Swiss manufacture are used exclusively in this section of Cuba. They were introduced years ago and have dominated this market ever since. They are reputed to be much cheaper than the nails of American manufacture and superior in both flexibility and tenacity. No American horseshoe nails are on sale in the retail stores."

The German government has forbidden further exportation of German moving picture films to Sweden. We wonder why? Didn't the Swedish audiences cheer loudly enough when the Kaiser was shown in the foreground of every picture? Or is it that maybe Sweden does not appreciate "kultur"?

Writing from South America, a government trade agent says there is a wonderful opening there for the sale of a preparation for whitening shoes. Somebody ought to bottle Clackamas county dust and ship it to South

America. We know of no better way to whiten shoes than to walk along almost any county road. And the dust won't come off, either.

Last week we saw the editor of the Courier carefully and painstakingly correct the correspondence from a certain section, and on looking over his shoulder, we saw he was making a certain word read "thrashing." When we asked him about it, he said "thrashing" was the correct way to spell it and to pronounce it. And now comes a government report, prepared and sanctioned by Uncle Sam, on "Steam Thrashing Machines in Russia." And all the way through the report it is "thrashing," and not "thrashing." We guess the editor isn't as wise as he thought he was.

John Stark doesn't like to have us quote the Daily Consular Reports, but John didn't get into the paper last week, so maybe he is away somewhere. Hence we feel free to indulge in our favorite reading this week. And we see that Vice-consul John W. Dye, at Cape Town, South Africa, tells his Uncle Samuel that the South African Railways have just ordered a lot of "whale cars"—designed to transport whole whales—out here in the Northwest we cut 'em up as soon as we can after catching them, and burn what is left. It leaves the air in a more attractive state. South Africa must smell worse than the sulphide end of the paper mills when a train of "whale cars" goes past.

Speaking of chances for business in Columbia, our Uncle Sam informs us that "the language of the country is Spanish. Purchases can be made in any language, but sales can only be made in Spanish." Now what we want to know is this: when the United States receives a trade letter in United States language, how does he know whether it deals with a purchase or a sale till it is translated; and after he has found out, why won't he talk business in United States if it doesn't offer him a chance to unload something?

Columbia appears to be unique among the nations of the earth. Uncle Sam says so. He gives a list of things that the Columbians manufacture, and included in the list is this: "Petroleum, gasoline and fuel oils; competition impossible." Just think of that—there is one place where Standard Oil cannot cut in and underbid prices for local trade!

That ought to interest John Stark and make him want to go there.

Consul Wilbur T. Gracey cables his government from Seville, Spain, as follows: "There is a shortage here of dried and shredded codfish. Prices and terms are required immediately. Address American Consulate, Seville, Spain." The consul must be hungry, or maybe he is expecting King Alfonso to dinner. We suggest that if he can't get codfish, he try canned salmon.

Cablegram from E. W. Thompson, at The Hague, comes to Uncle Sam as follows: "Fertilizer factories are combining to build sulphuric-acid works." This sounds as if the Dove of Peace was getting ready to fly from Andy Carnegie's palace in The Netherlands.

Somehow this sounds familiar. It is from Consul J. H. Goodier, at Niagara Falls, Canada. He says: "A jitney bus service inaugurated in this city the first of this week is well patronized. Passengers are carried across the city for 5 cents. As the jitney route parallels the local



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streetcar line, the railway company has protested to the municipal authorities against allowing a continuance of this jitney service. The company says that it pays large taxes on its property and franchise, while the promoters of the jitney service are only required to take out the usual licenses at small expense. The matter will be considered by the city council shortly.

We presume some councilman there will play the same role on behalf of the railway company as was played in our own county seat by the author of the ordinance to regulate "public utility vehicles." It is funny how there is always a handy man around.

"Printing with a punch"—at the Courier.

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